

Like other young artists, Leonardo had little time or money to promote himself. He needed to concentrate on his art, hoping that whatever he produced would put him in demand. But how long would it take to establish himself? That was impossible to say.

DID YOU KNOW?

Leonardo never married or had children. The assistants who lived with him, sometimes for several years, were as close as he came to having his own family.

At least Leonardo was in the right place to make that happen. Florence was one of the major cities of western Europe.

In the 1470s, the city was a bustling place of over 40,000 people. Its rulers were the Medicis,

The city of Florence is home to many fine Renaissance buildings.

